receive the morally appropriate rewards and punishments for our actions even as we receive the physical rewards for such actions as touching a fire or putting our hands into freezing water. This is what is meant by the Law of Karma. Firm belief in the Law of Karma has made the Hindus more Dharma-minded and God-fearing than other races in the world.

MAN, IMMORTALITY, AND REINCARNATION

From the Supreme Being, or God, and the objective and the eternal reality of the Dharma, or the moral nature of the universe, we move on to man. Like all other theistic religions, Hinduism believes man to be finite, an unborn and undying spirit, completely different from the complex of his body and mind. But the Hindus have gone theoretically a little deeper into the implications of a man's immortality with reference to its psychological and moral nature of the self. This has led them to believe not only in a single life on this earth but in an unending series of continued lives called the theory of *Āvāgaman*, or reincarnation, literally "coming and going." According to this theory, the immortal spirit in man reincarnates itself after each death, in a better or a worse form of life, according to the demands of man's psychological ambitions and the necessity of the ethical rewards and punishments of his actions. In other religions of the world, this need for ethical justice is justified by the theory of a day of final judgment after a single life, which, though considered by the Hindus as purely a matter of simple faith, is perhaps equally successful for the justification of the moral needs of life. It is not contended that the Hindu theory of reincarnation is as certain as any other empirical fact, but, theoretically, it seems more consistent with the demands of reason and empirical continuity inasmuch as something more is considered to be necessary for moral justice than a mere belief that ultimately all psychological and ethical differences in a man's life are somehow to be computed before the final dissolution of the universe. This does not, to the Hindu, explain the original differences of birth, heredity, and the circumstances of a man's life which are the root of all the injustice to him. The two Hindu theories of reincarnation and the Law of Karma are held to be more consistent with the causal needs of having a proper beginning and ending to a single life of unaccountable differences of heredity and destiny between men. Since nothing can come out of nothing, and since something existing cannot just pass out of existence, man has to be somewhere before he is born and after he is dead without